MIL-T-3527D

31 December 1974

SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-3527C
29 March 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TEA, INSTANT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers instant tea, and instant tea with sweetener and lemon flavor with or without ascorbic acid, or with or without carbohydrates, for use by the Armed Forces as an item of general issue and as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of following types and classes, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Tea with added carbohydrate

Type II - Tea without added carbohydrate

Type III - Tea with sweetener and lemon flavor

Class A - Without ascorbic acid, (types I, II and III)

Class B - With ascorbic acid, (types I, II and III)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock, (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes

FSC 8955

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PPP-G-460 - Glass Containers, One-Gallon Capacity and Smaller, for Other Than Medicinal Products; Packaging and Packing of

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

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National Research Council

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Director, National Academy of Sciences, National Research Council, 2101 Constitution Avenue, Washington, DC 20418.)

Association of Vitamin Chemists

Methods of Vitamin Assay

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Interscience Publishers, a Division of John Wiley and Sons, Inc., 605 Third Avenue, New York, NY 10016.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

U.S. Army Natick Laboratories

Food Technology - Hedonic Scale Method of Measuring Food Preferences

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Army Natick Laboratories, ATTN: STSNL-WTE, Natick, MA 01760.)

American Public Health Association

Sediment Chart

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1790 Broadway, New York, NY 10019.)

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(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Bid sample approval. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), 6 jars, each containing 1-1/2 ounces (43 g) of type I product, or 6 jars, each containing 3/4 ounce (21 g) of type II product, or 6 jars of type III product, each containing 24 ounces (680 g) representative of the products which the supplier proposes to furnish under contract, shall be submitted to the contracting officer at the time of submission of the bid and shall be tested to the extent necessary to properly evaluate the subjective qualities of the products. Testing of bid samples shall include panel testing for palatability (see 4.4.2.6). Each bid sample shall be labeled with type, weight, and preparation directions. Approval shall be in accordance with established standards and control limits (see 4.4.3).

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Tea. Only black tea shall be used.

* 3.2.2 Carbohydrates. The added carbohydrate material shall be maltodextrin, dextrose, or corn sirup, or any combination of these.

3.2.3 Ascorbic acid. Ascorbic acid shall be of Food Chemicals Codex grade. The ascorbic acid crystals shall be of the size necessary to obtain a homogeneous mixture when mixed with the instant tea.

3.2.4 Natural lemon flavor. The natural lemon flavor shall be entrapped or encapsulated by incorporation in vegetable gum, sorbitol, dextrose or other edible material, in such a manner that the flavor is protected from oxidation, rancidity, evaporation or other types of deterioration.

3.2.5 Antioxidants. The antioxidants e.g., BHA or BHT or a combination thereof shall be of Food Chemicals Codex quality.

3.2.6 Sugar. The sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar or a combination thereof.

3.2.7 Acids. Food acidulants shall conform to the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex. Fumaric acid, if used, shall be treated with dioctylsodium sulfosuccinate to enhance rapid solubility in cold water.

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3.2.8 Coloring. Coloring materials shall be vegetable colors or approved U.S. certified food colors and shall be acid resistant.

3.2.9 Tricalcium phosphate. Tricalcium phosphate may be added, and shall conform to Food Chemicals Codex requirements.

* 3.2.10 Sodium citrate. Sodium citrate of Food Chemicals Codex quality may be added in amounts suitable to provide desired buffering effect.

3.3 Finished product. Finished product shall be clean, sound and wholesome, free from lumps, and shall possess a uniform light brown color. In addition, the finished product shall meet the analytical, solubility and palatability requirements of 3.3.1 through 3.3.3.

3.3.1 Analytical requirements.

3.3.1.1 Moisture. The moisture content of the (types I and II) finished product shall be not more than 4.0 percent, type III shall contain not more than 0.40 percent moisture. Moisture determination shall be made as specified in 4.4.2.1.

3.3.1.2 Caffeine. The caffeine content of type I shall be not less than 2.5 percent, not less than 5.0 percent for type II, and not less than 0.110 percent for type III, on a dry solids basis, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.3.

3.3.1.3 Sugars. The sugars, after hydrolysis, shall be not more than 63 percent reducing for type I and not more than 26 percent reducing for type II, on the dry basis, calculated as dextrose, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.4. For type III the total sugar (sucrose plus reducing sugar) shall not exceed 96 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.2.4.

* 3.3.1.4 Ascorbic acid. The added ascorbic acid content of class B product shall be not less than 15 mg. on a lot average basis, per 1.30 grams (g.) of type I product or 0.65 g. of type II product, when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.2. In type III product ascorbic acid may be added in amounts used in normal commercial practice.

3.3.1.5 Titratable acidity. The type III product shall contain not less than 2.4 percent titratable acidity (dry basis) when tested as specified in 4.4.2.5.

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3.3.2 Solubility. One and three tenths grams of type I or 0.65 g. of type II or 14.2 grams of type III shall be readily soluble in 8 ounce (237 cc) of boiling water or cold water (55°F.) (13°C.). Testing shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

3.3.3 Palatibility. All deliveries shall be equal to or better than the bid sample submitted when tested according to 4.4.2.6.

3.4 All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.5 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged under modern sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirement of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection. Product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.5.

4.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Inspection of components (examination and testing). In accordance with 4.1 above, components shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

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4.3.1.1 Ingredients. Conformance of ingredients to identity requirements e.g. (kind, quality standards, strength, composition, as applicable to each ingredient) shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent labels, invoices or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to 3.2 and as may be contained in the pertinent ingredient requirement paragraph. The sample unit for examination shall be 1/4 pound (114 gm) of ingredient derived from a primary container. The sample size shall be five. In the event a lot consists of less than five containers, a sample unit shall be taken from each container in the lot. Nonconformance with identity requirements or one or more sample units not conforming to condition requirements shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.1.2 Envelope material. Conformance of envelope material to 5.1.1.1 shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent invoices, labels or other valid documents from the suppliers of envelope material. Nonconformance shall indicate unacceptable envelope material and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.3.2 Examination of end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with tables II through VI and 4.3.2.1 through 4.3.2.3. Sampling plans for the aforementioned tables shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for all tables except table III which shall be expressed as percent defective.

TABLE I. Sampling plans and AQLs

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs		
				Major A	Major B	Minor
II	1	1 envelope or jar	Envelopes or jars	0.25	1.0	4.0
III	S-3	1 envelope or jar	Envelopes or jars	-	-	1.5
IV	S-3	1 envelope	Envelopes	-	1.0	-
V	S-2	1/	Cases	-	-	1.5
VI	S-2	1 envelope or jar	Envelopes or jars	-	1.0	-

1/ 1 carton or corrugated nontest box (levels A and B pack) or 1 shipping container (level C pack).

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* TABLE II. Examination of primary containers

Category			Defect	Defects applicable to Envelopes	Glass Jar
Major A	Major B	Minor			
101			Tear, hole or open seal	X	
	151		Not type or size specified	X	X
	152		Delamination	X	
		201	Color of the 1-serve envelope not dull yellow or light brown	X	
	153		Objectionable odor	X	
	154		Nomenclature missing, incorrect or illegible	X	X
	155		Directions for use missing, incorrect, or illegible	X	X
		202	Other required label information missing, incorrect, or illegible	X	X
	156		Not clean	X	X
	157		Not heat sealed on all four sides	X	
	158		Broken, chipped or thin spot		X
	159		Cap insecure		X
	160		Pitted rust on cap		X

TABLE III. Examination of net weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Less than 0.62 gram (for 0.65 gram envelope)
202	Less than 20.2 grams for 3/4 ounce (21.3 gram envelopes)
203	Less than 1.2 grams (for 1.3 gram envelopes)

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TABLE III. Examination of net weight 1/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Minor	
204	Less than 181.8 grams (for 6-3/4 ounce (191 gm) glass jars
205	Less than 23-1/2 ounces (665 gm) (for 24 ounce (679 gm) glass jar)

1/ Weighing device shall be calibrated in increments of no larger than 0.01 gram increments for .65 and 1.3 gram envelopes; 0.1 gram for 3/4 ounce (21 gm) envelopes, 1 gram for 3/4 ounce (21 gm) envelopes and 1/8 ounce (4 gm) for 6-3/4 ounces (191 gm) and 24 ounce (679 gm) jars.

TABLE IV. Examination for leakage and delamination of laminate of envelopes (see 4.4.1.1)

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Leakage
152	Delamination 1/

1/ Examine envelope after removal from water.

TABLE V. Examination for count of envelopes 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Less than 195 or less than 49 1-serve envelopes per carton or less than 49 multiple-serve envelopes per corrugated nontest box

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TABLE V. Examination for count of envelopes 1/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Minor	
202	More than 2-1/2 percent (to nearest unit) under marked count (applicable to level C pack)

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate a lot average count of envelopes less than required count.

TABLE VI. Examination of product characteristics 1/

Category	Defect
Major B	Powder
151	Not uniform brown color
152	Not free from lumps
	Prepared beverage 2/
153	Palatability not equal to or better than the bid sample

1/ Presence of foreign material, e.g., metal, wood, glass, filth, etc., shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Prepare beverage by adding 8 ounces (246 ml) of boiling water to 1.30 g. of type I product or 0.65 g. of type II and 14.2 grams for type III product. Make one determination per sample unit.

4.3.2.1 Examination of waterproof case liner. Examination of filled and closed waterproof case liners shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-10547.

4.3.2.2 Examination of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, the filled and closed shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with the appendix of the specification.

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In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Major - Markings missing, incorrect or illegible; Minor - Marking for net weight indicates a new weight of more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) for types I and II, nor more than 20 pounds (9 kg) for type III. For level C pack, the above examination criteria shall apply except that only the defects pertinent to marking shall be applicable. Examination of filled and sealed shipping containers for glass jars shall be in accordance with the examination criteria container in PPP-G-460.

4.3.2.3 Examination of unit loads. When loads are required to be palletized, examination of such loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

4.3.3 Testing of finished product. The finished product shall be tested for moisture, sugars (as applicable), caffeine and ascorbic acid, and titratable acidity as applicable to the type and class of product. Test requirements shall be average requirements. The sample for testing shall be an 8 ounce (226 gm) composite of product derived from the number of primary containers indicated by inspection level S-2, except that for individual service envelopes, the sample shall be derived from the number of envelopes necessary to yield 8 ounces (226 gm). Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the primary container. The composite shall be formed just prior to testing. Results shall be reported to the same unit or decimal place as specified for the pertinent requirement. A test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.1 Solubility. The sample unit for testing shall be 1.30 g. of type I or 0.65 g. of type II and 14.2 grams of type III product (removed from an envelope or a jar just prior to testing), and the sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. The AQL, expressed as percent defective, shall be 1.5. A test result which shows sedimentation in excess of the 0.5 mg. standard sediment disk shall be a defect.

4.4 Examination and test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute, as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

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4.4.1 Examination procedures.

4.4.1.1 Leakage examination. The filled and sealed envelope shall be examined for leakage by submerging in water, contained in a desiccator or other suitable container and maintaining a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage.

4.4.2 Test procedures.

4.4.2.1 Moisture. The moisture content of the finished product shall be determined as follows:

(a) Dry 2 to 3 g. of sample in a dried flat weighing dish (Ni, Pt or Al) with tight-fitting cover at 70°C. under pressure of not over 100 millimeters (mm) of mercury for 6 hours.

(b) Remove dish from oven, put cover in place, cool in desiccator, and weigh. (NOTE: Oven should be bled with current of dry air during drying to insure removal of water vapors).

4.4.2.2 Ascorbic acid. Samples of instant tea shall be taken from the same lot, before and after fortifying with ascorbic acid. The amount of ascorbic acid in the product will be calculated by difference in the assay values of the unfortified and the fortified samples. Ascorbic acid shall be determined by the method described in Methods of Vitamin Assay of the Association of Vitamin Chemists, Inc., 3rd edition (ascorbic acid, page 304 (3) - 306).

4.4.2.3 Caffeine. Caffeine content for types I, II and III shall be determined by the Modified Bailey-Andrew method as outlined in Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Coffee and Tea, section: Tea.

4.4.2.4 Sugars. The method for determining sugars as described in Official Methods of Analysis, of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Coffee and Tea, Sugars, method: Sugars, Either Reducing Sugars or Sucrose.

4.4.2.5 Titratable acidity. Titratable acidity shall be determined as outlined in Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Coffee and Tea, section: Tea, method: Total acidity, (as citric or malic, as applicable).

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4.4.2.6 Palatability testing. Palatability testing of bid samples and, when specified (see 6.1), deliveries shall be conducted as follows: Samples shall be tested by a consumer panel consisting of not less than 24 persons. The samples shall be prepared for testing by dissolving the instant tea in boiling water in the proportion of 1.30 g. for type I or 0.65 g. for type II per 8 fluid ounces (237 ml) of water. The samples shall be cooled and served to the panel members for rating on a 9-point scale * graduated in successive degrees of like and dislike as shown below. The samples shall be served in porcelain or glass containers in at least 2 ounce (57 g) portions at a temperature of 145°F. (63°C) ± 2°F. (± 1°C). The subjects shall test without interference either from each other or from outsiders. Each subject shall rate no more than 4 samples at a test session.

9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1
Like extremely	Like very much	Like moderately	Like slightly	Neither like nor dislike	Dislike slightly	Dislike moderately	Dislike very much	Dislike extremely

NOTE: For further details, see Hedonic Scale Methods of Measuring Food Preferences, reprinted from Food Technology, 1957, vol. XI, No. 9, Supplemental Pages 9-14.

4.4.2.6.1 Establishment of reference standards. Referenced standards will be established as needed and shall be brands of instant tea offered by or available from manufacturers controlling their own processing facilities. The acceptability of the sample shall be determined by means of a consumer preference survey with at least 50 responses to each brand tested using the 9-point scale (see 4.4.2.6). All brands which do not rate significantly lower at the 5-percent level than the brand with the highest rating, shall be used as reference standards.

4.4.3 Determination of acceptability of bid samples. The distribution of ratings of the bid sample shall be compared with the distribution of ratings of the reference standard obtained during the same test session. A sample shall be considered acceptable when its mean rating is not significantly lower at the 5-percent level than the mean rating of the reference standard.

4.4.4 Solubility test (sediment disk procedure, apparatus, and materials). The sediment filtering apparatus described in the Official Methods of Analysis, Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Extraneous Materials: Isolation; section: Dairy Products; method: Sediment Test on Milk,

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or a method giving equivalent results, shall be used. The construction of the filtering apparatus should be such as to allow the use of suction and to expose an effective filtering area of 1-1/8 inches (28.mm) in diameter, which should be unobstructed except for the wire screen needed to support the filter media. The filter media should be Johnson and Johnson lintine sediment disks, or disks giving equivalent results. The water required in the test shall be distilled water cooled to a temperature of 55°F (13°C). Procedure: When testing for types I, II and III products, weigh 1.30 g. for type I, 0.65 g. for type II, or 14.2 grams for type III into 400 ml. beaker. Add 25 ml. of water and allow the tea to spread over the surface of the water for 15 seconds. While stirring vigorously, add 200 ml. additional water and continue stirring. No more than 1 minute should elapse from the first addition of water to the start of filtration. Filter the solution using just enough suction to keep a rapid continuous flow without allowing the surface of the filtering media to become exposed while the solution is being poured into the apparatus. Total time of filtration should be less than 1 minute. Wash down the sides of the funnel of the filtering apparatus with 25 ml. of water and increase suction to help dry the filter disk. Grade the disks prepared from the tea sample to the nearest standard disk specified in the American Public Health Association Sediment Chart. Any distinct stains or spots indicate aggregates of undissolved tea and should be counted as sediment for the purpose of this test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with levels A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. The product shall be packaged in envelopes in accordance with 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

* 5.1.1.1 One-serving unit. One and three tenths grams of type I product or 0.65 grams of type II product and 14.2 grams of type III product shall be packaged in an envelope which shall be heat sealed on all four sides. The dimensions of the sealed envelope, containing the product, shall be not more than 2-5/8 inches square (17 cm^2) or 2-3/8 (60.3 mm) by 3 inches (76.2 mm), and not more than 1/8-inch (3.2 mm) thick. The filled and sealed envelope shall not show leakage or delamination when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.1. The envelope material shall be made by hot-extruding polyethylene on 0.00035-inch (0.0089 mm) thick aluminum foil, and laminating the plain side of the foil to sulphite or kraft paper. The polyethylene shall have a minimum thickness of 0.001 inch (.03 mm). The paper shall have a basis weight of 25 to 30 (11.3 to 13.6 kg) pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 500) and shall be treated or processed

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to form a soft, pliable sheet. The adhesive for laminating the foil to paper shall be a suitable odorless and permanently plastic, water-resistant compound other than wax. The combined sheet shall show no evidence of delamination when made into envelopes or heat sealed. The outside of the complete packet shall be a dull yellow or light brown color. When specified (see 6.1), 200 envelopes of type I or II product or 50 envelopes of type III product shall be packaged in a folding or set-up paperboard carton.

* 5.1.1.2 Multiple-serving unit. Three-quarters of an ounce (21 g) of type II product shall be filled into an envelope. The envelope which shall be heat sealed on all four sides shall be constructed of material as specified in 5.1.1.1, except that the color and dimension requirements shall not apply. The filled and sealed envelope shall not show leakage when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.1. Fifty envelopes shall be packed in a non-test corrugated domestic fiberboard box.

5.1.2 Level C.

* 5.1.2.1 Glass jars. Six and three-quarter ounces (191 gm) of type I and II, class A product or twenty-four ounces (679 gm) of the type III product shall be packaged in a glass jar which affords adequate protection against deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. Jars shall be fitted with a 70 mm. cap to make them suitable for use in standard tea dispensing equipment. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

* 5.1.2.2 One serving unit. The product shall be packaged in a manner to protect it from deterioration or damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1 and 5.2.2, as applicable.

5.2.1 Glass jars. Twelve or twenty-four glass jars of the product shall be packed into a shipping container in accordance with levels A, B or C requirements of PPP-B-460, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.2 Envelopes. The product packaged in envelopes shall be packed in accordance with levels A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

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5.2.2.1 Level A.

* 5.2.2.1.1 One-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the type I or II product nor more than 20 pounds (9.07 kg) of the type III product shall be packaged and overpacked in folding or set-up paperboard cartons, as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting nontest corrugated fiberboard box and placed in a waterproof case liner, fabricated and closed in accordance with MIL-L-10547 for subsistence items. The filled and sealed box, inclosed in a waterproof case liner, shall then be overpacked in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, made, sealed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2.1.2 Multiple-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg), of the product, packaged and overpacked in fiberboard boxes as specified in 5.1.1.2, shall be overpacked in a waterproof case liner and fiberboard box as specified in 5.2.2.1.1.

5.2.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.2.1 One-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, packaged and overpacked in folding or set-up paperboard cartons as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be provided with a waterproof case liner as specified in 5.2.2.1.1.

5.2.2.2.2 Multiple-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, packaged and overpacked in fiberboard boxes as specified in 5.1.1.2, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be provided with a waterproof case liner as specified in 5.2.2.1.1.

5.2.2.2.3 When specified (see 6.1), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2.2.1 shall be reinforced with non-metallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.3 Level C.

5.2.2.3.1 One-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 and overpacked in folding or set-up paperboard cartons as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be provided with a waterproof case liner as specified in 5.2.2.1.1.

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* 5.2.2.3.2 Multiple-serving unit. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, packaged and overpacked in fiberboard boxes as specified in 5.1.1.2, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be provided with a waterproof case liner as specified in 5.2.2.1.1.

5.2.2.3.3 Shipment to ration assembly. Not more than 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of the product, packaged in envelopes as specified in 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2 or when specified (see 6.1) 5.1.2.2, shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

* 5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1) the product packed as specified in 5.2 shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

* 5.4 Labeling and marking.

* 5.4.1 Envelopes. Envelopes containing 1.3, 0.65 and 14.2 grams of the product shall be labeled with the following information in black, bold-faced type:

INSTANT TEA (in letters larger than any others on the envelope)
Fortified (when applicable)
1.3, 0.65 and 14.2 grams (as applicable)

Directions:

Dissolve contents in 1/3 canteen cup (8 fluid ounces) (246 ml) of hot or cold water.
Stir well.

_____.
Name and address of contractor.

Any other information required by the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

Envelopes containing 3/4 ounce (21 g) of the product shall be marked in accordance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder. Directions for use shall be a part of the label in accordance with the manufacturer's preparation formula.

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* 5.4.2 Glass jars. Labeling shall be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

* 5.4.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

* 5.4.4 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class of product required (see 1.2).
(c) When other than 6 bid samples are required for approval (see 3.1).
(d) When deliveries are to be submitted for palatability testing (see 4.4.2.6).
(e) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Whether 1-serving or multiple-serving units are required (see 5.1.1).
(g) When 200 envelopes containing 1-serving units are to be packaged in folding or set-up paperboard carton (see 5.1.1.1).
(h) When packing specified in 5.2.2.2.3 or 5.2.2.3.3 is required.
(i) Type and class of load when unit loading specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Packing specified in 5.2.2.2.1 and 5.2.2.2.2 is intended to provide the limited Military protection required for: shipment of supplies to certain specified overseas destinations; transfer at sea; and for shipment and storage of Special Program Reserves.

6.3 Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFR 71-6, MCO 4030.14D and DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.4 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP-SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8955-0028

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-T-3527D TEA, INSTANT

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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